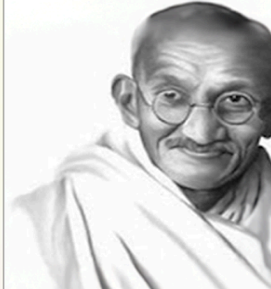


General Knowledge

Modern History

STUDY NOTES

Gandhi Movements



Gandhi Movements

Mohandas Karamchand Gandhi was born on October 2, 1869, in Porbandar in the princely state of Kathiawar in Gujarat. He studied law in England. M.K. Gandhi's political career started first in South Africa and then carried forward in India. He gave a new method of fighting for freedom.



Gandhi's South Africa Stint:

- **Gandhi went to South Africa** in connection with a **case involving his client Dada Abdulla**.
- In South Africa, he **witnessed the ugly face of white racism, humiliation, and contempt for Asians** who had gone to South Africa as **laborers**.
- Hence, **he decided to stay** in South Africa to **organize Indian workers to enable them to fight for their rights. He stayed till 1914**.
- Here, Gandhi **evolved his experiments with the truth**.
- Later, he **applied his experiments in India** during the national movement
- His **discovery of Satyagraha** gave the Indian freedom struggle a rejuvenated direction.

Gandhi's Evolution in South Africa



Political activities in South Africa:

Moderate Phase of struggle(1894-1906):

- The **method** of struggle was to **send petitions and memorials** to the authorities.
- The **objective** was to **alert the British authorities of the situation of Indian laborers**. Also, to **force** the British to redress it with **sincere steps**.

- **The Natal Indian Congress** was set up to unite different sections of Indians and also started an **Indian opinion** newspaper.

The Phase of Passive Resistance of Satyagraha (1906-1914):

Against Registration Certificates:

- The new **legislation** in South Africa made **Indians carry registration certificates** along with their fingerprints.
- **Gandhi decided not to follow** this measure and formed a **Passive Resistance Association** to a **campaign of defying the law** and suffering all the penalties resulting from it.
- Indians **publicly burned the registration certificates**.
- The government made a **compromise settlement later** to avoid a bad image.

Against Restrictions of Indian Migration:

- Gandhi **campaigned against a law** that restricted Indian migration.
- The **Indians defied the law by crossing over the provinces** and refused to produce licenses.

Against the Poll Tax and Invalidation of Indian Marriages:

- The **anger** was created against the **3 Pounds poll tax** imposed on all ex-indentured laborers.
- Additionally, the anger was raised by the **Supreme Court judgment on invalidating marriages** that were not in line with the **Christian rites**. It held **Hindu, Muslim, and Parsi marriages illegal**.
- Hence, Gandhi launched a **combined campaign against the issues**.

Against Transvaal Immigration Act:

- The **law** made **immigration from Natal to Transvaal migration illegal**.
- **G.K. Gokhale mobilized the opinion in support** of Indians in South Africa and

called for an **impartial inquiry**.

- Finally, under the leadership of Gandhi, the South African authorities were able to reach a **compromise solution** in which **major Indian demands related to poll tax registration, registration certificates, and marriages were solemnized according to Indian rites** and **promised to treat the issue of Indian migration in a sympathetic manner**.
- **Gandhi's campaign in South Africa was a successful effort and he got the confidence to do the same in his homeland India.**



Gandhi in South Africa

Point To Remember:

- Associations in South Africa to which Gandhi was associated:
 - **The Natal Indian Congress.**
 - **Passive Resistance Association.**

Gandhi's Principles & Satyagraha:

- Gandhi believed in the Jainism principles and hence, tried to live his life on **six beliefs**:
 - **Truth,**
 - **Non-violence,**
 - **Vegetarianism,**

- **Brahmacharya,**
- **Simplicity, and**
- **Faith.**

Gandhi's Beliefs

Vegetarianism

Non-violence

The principle of avoiding harm to any living being.

A lifestyle choice that reflects compassion for animals.

Brahmacharya

The practice of self-control and celibacy for spiritual growth.

Truth

The foundation of honesty and integrity in all actions.

Simplicity

Embracing a life free from unnecessary complexities.



Satyagraha:

- Gandhi evolved the method of struggle using the Satyagraha technique. He **experimented with it in South Africa for the first time.**
- It was **based on two prime factors** which are **Truth and non-violence.**
- The **basic features** of Satyagraha are as follows:
 1. Satyagrahi should **always remain truthful, nonviolent, and fearless.**
 2. Satyagraha works peacefully on the **principles of noncooperation and civil disobedience.**
 3. **Satyagraha's methods include non-payment of taxes, peaceful protests, returning honors, etc.**
 4. Satyagrahi should protest in the **love of following the truth and not for hatred.**

5. Satyagrahi should be brave enough to **accept all the sufferings in his struggle.**

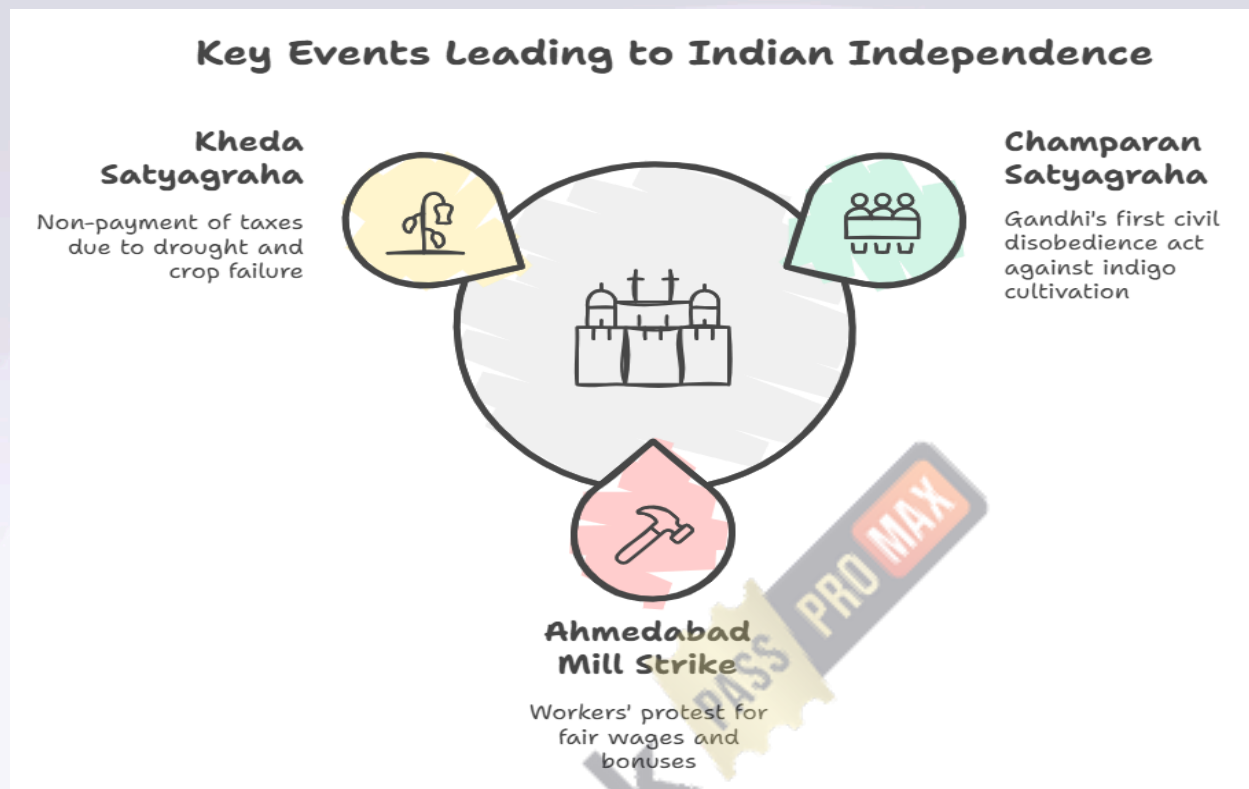
Arrival in India(1915):

- **1915** was considered as the arrival of Gandhi to India. His **first act was to make all India tours.**
- His objectives were:
 1. Understand the **Indian sufferings.**
 2. Understand the **position of British authority.**
 3. Understand the **scenario of political associations** in India
 4. **Not to join any political party** or take any political position.
 5. **Understand the mass capacity of Indians** and the factors **needed** to unite the people.



- He **realized that this nonviolent Satyagraha technique was capable of making India independent.**
- Hence he decided to **first inculcate the non-violent Satyagraha principles among the people** of India.
- He started his **political agenda through three popular struggles** namely ***Champaran Satyagraha, Ahmedabad mill strike, and Kheda Satyagraha.***

Early Movements & involvement of early Satyagrahis in India:



Champaran Satyagraha(1917):

- European planters **forced peasants to grow Indigo on the Tin-Kathia system.**
- **German dyes replaced the British Indigo** which reduced the European planter's revenue.
- Hence, authorities **demand high rents and legal dues** to maximize the profit.
- Additionally, authorities **forced peasants to sell at prices fixed** by Europeans.
- It was the **first act of the Civil Disobedience Movement.**
- **Civil disobedience was launched under the leadership of Gandhi by not paying the rent and dues.**
- Other Satyagrahis: **Rajendra Prasad, JB Kripalani, Mazhar Ul Haq, Anugrah Narayan, Mahadev Desai, Nahari Parekh etc.**

Point To Remember:***Tin-Kathia System:***

- It's an **economic policy enforced by the East India Company mostly in the Bengal region.**
- It's a **unit measurement of land.**
- In this system, The British **forced the Indian peasants to grow only Indigo in every 3 out of 20 Kathas in each Bigha.**

**Champaran Satyagraha****Ahmedabad Mill Strike (1918):**

- The issue was the **discontinuation of the plague bonus** paid to workers by mill owners.
- **Workers demanded an increase of 50% in wages** to manage the wartime inflation. **But owners only gave 20% of the bonus to 50% of the people.**
- In the protest, several workers left the city which **created a shortage of workforce.**

- A **compromise settlement** was made under the leadership of Gandhi in which **35% of bonuses** were approved.
- For the **first time**, Gandhi did a '**fast till death protest**.'
- Other Satyagrahis: **Anusuya Sarabhai**.

Kheda Satyagraha (1918):

- There was a **severe drought in 1918** that caused crop failure.
- The **revenue code** said that if crop **production is less than 25%**, the government will **remit the rents**.
- Peasant presented a petition to suspend the revenue assessment of the year. **However, the British were adamant and warned to pay a commission or lose the land.**
- Gandhi launched the **Non-cooperation Movement**.
- **Features:**
 - **Tax revolt.**
 - **Non-violent** demand.
 - Those who **wanted to buy confiscated land** were **boycotted and ostracised**.
- It was the **first act of the Non-cooperation Movement**. in which **Gandhi became an undisputed leader**.
- Other Satyagrahis: **Nana Parikh, Ravi Vyas, Sardar Patel**.

Point To Remember:

- **Champaran Satyagraha:** It was the **first act of the Civil Disobedience Movement**.
- **Ahmedabad Mill Strike:** For the **first time**, '**fast till death protest**'.
- **Kheda Satyagraha:** It was the **first Non-cooperation Movement**.

All India Home-rule League (1916-1918):

- Gandhi participated in it. It was a **self-rule awareness movement**.

Rowlatt Act (1919):

- **Anarchical and Revolutionary Crimes Act** which had provision of **arrest without warrant for 2 years**.
- Gandhi launched **Satyagraha Sabha** to condemn this as a **Black Act**.

Jallianwala Bagh massacre(1919):

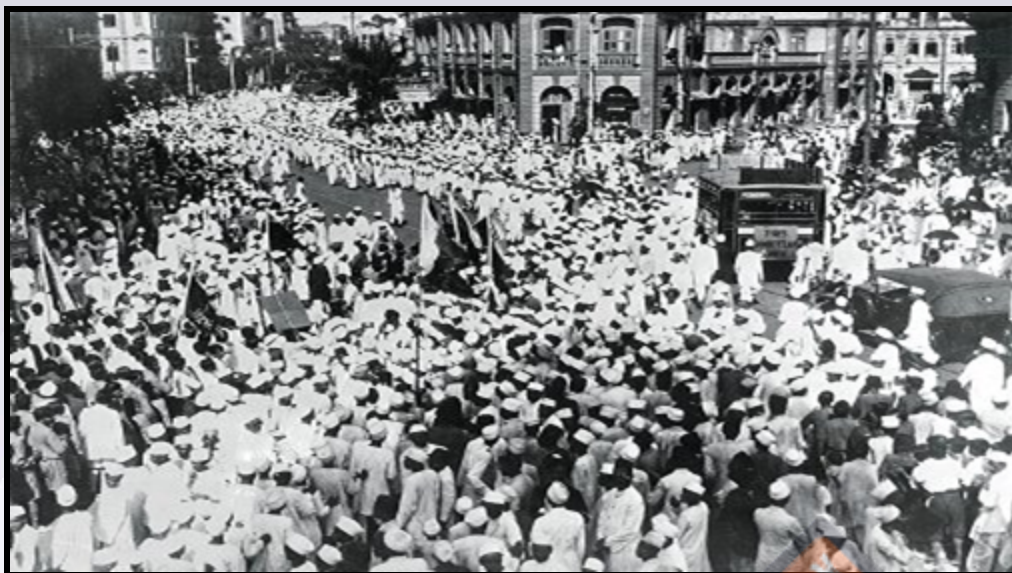
- **Massive killings of innocent Indians** in Punjab by **General Dyer**.
- Gandhi **demanded lawful action** against Dyer.

Khilafat Movement (1919):

- **Anger amongst Muslims** on the **Treaty of Sevres about decommissioning the Caliphate position**.
- **Gandhi chaired the All India Khilafat Congress committee** to support this movement.
- The **idea was to unite Hindus and Muslims** in the national movement.

First Mass Movement in India: Non-Cooperation Movement

- It was also **called the Non-Cooperation Movement**.
- **Gandhi** was the **main leader**.
- His **idea was to unite the following issues** and launch a nationwide movement:
 1. **Punjab injustice.**
 2. **Khilafat issue.**
 3. **Swarajya.**
 4. **Famine issues after World War I.**



Success:

- **Mass participation:**
 - The sections like **Workers, Industrialists, Peasants, Zamindars, Students and Women** participated actively in the movement.
- **Great geographical reach:**
 - The **movement** touched almost every **part of the country**.
 - Even in some parts, **local agitation was made**. Eg. Many **local movements** were initiated like the **Bijolia movement in Mewar**.
- **Boycott of foreign goods:**
 - The **idea of a boycott** was to carry forward the Swadeshi movement. The only difference was this time it was **Pan-Indian in character**.
 - Eg. **Anti liquor campaigns in Punjab, Bihar, and Tamilnadu**.
- **Hindu-Muslim unity** was at its peak.
- **New educational institutions:**
 - The educational institutions were set up **to create national awareness**.
 - Eg. **Jamia Milia at Aligarh & Kashi Vidyapeeth at Banaras**.
- **Satyagrahi methods:**
 - Gandhi's method of Satyagraha was visible in many places.

- Eg. Renunciation of Honorary Titles by S.Iyer, Rabindranath Tagore, M.K.Gandhi.
- **The Emergence of New Leaders:**
 - **Young leaders** evolved in this movement like **Subhash Chandra Bose, JL Nehru, Sardar Patel, Bhagat Singh, etc.**

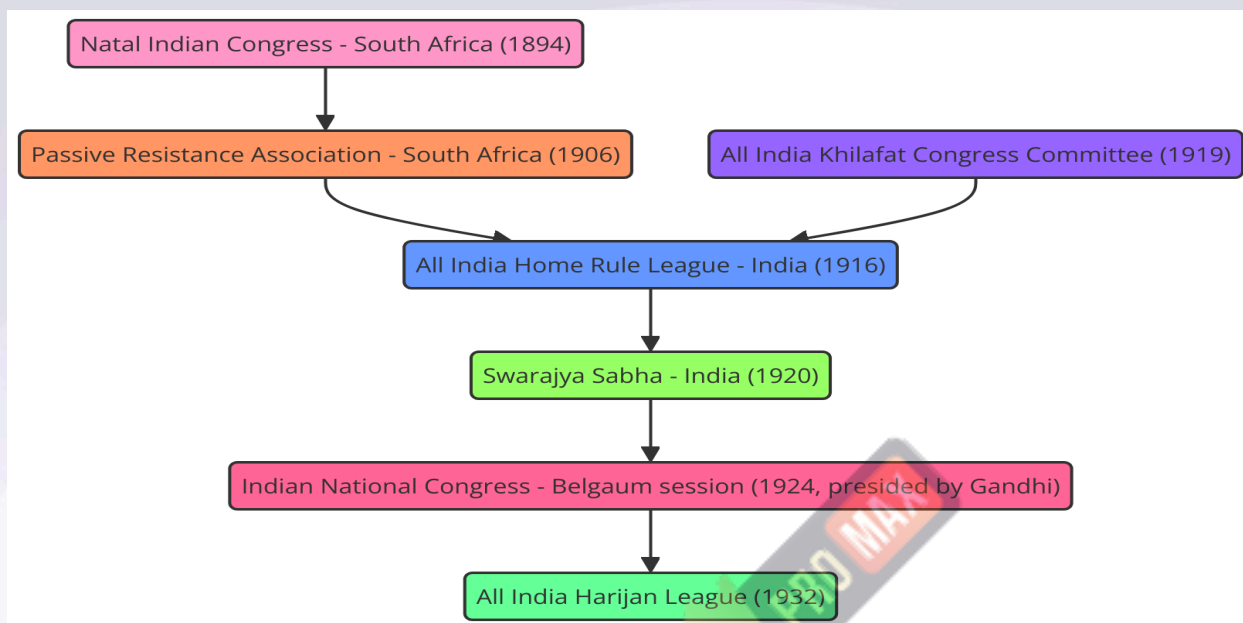
Weakness:

- **Middle-class participation was not impressive.**
- **Participation was reduced** when **authorities were forcing students to go back** to join colleges and schools. **Eg. at Nagpur division.**
- **Lawyers returned to practice.**
- **Expensive Indian-made products** like **Khadi** led to the buying of imported products again.
- **Communal riots like Moplah in Kerala and Chauri-Chaura in Bihar(1922)**)weakened Gandhi's method of Satyagraha. Hence, he called off the movement.
- **Revolutionary activities were started** again because of the failure of the movement.
- **Congress was divided** into **ones**, who believed in **fighting the British from inside the government** and **others**, to launch a **consistent mass movement instead.**
- **The future National Movements got a communal character** after non-cooperation.

Associations:

- **Gandhi was associated** with the following associations.
 1. **Natal Indian Congress: South Africa.**
 2. **Passive Resistance Association: South Africa**
 3. **All India home rule league: India**
 4. **Swarajya Sabha: Later version of All India Home Rule League.**
 5. **Indian National Congress: Belgaum session was chaired.**
 6. **All India Khilafat Congress committee.**

7. **All India Harijan League: To uplift the backward class people.**



M.K. Gandhi was the one who **gave the ideal direction to the freedom struggle of India**. His most **valuable contribution** was **converting localized movements into a nationalized movement**, no doubt why he is called '**Mahatma**' and '**Father of the Nation**'.